

China Grid Tech: Power Transformer Export Tracker: Aug total transformer exports -22% yoy but with exports to US at 542% yoy

In this latest **Power Transformer Export Tracker**, we provide an update as of Aug. **Pricing appeared stable at a high level, from US PPI, Korea and China export data as well as key raw material price perspectives, showing no signs of transformer shortage easing:** US PPI for power and specialty transformer maintained at +7.6% yoy in Aug; South Korea's large (>10MVA) transformers export pricing to the US stabilized at +6% yoy, +7% mom in Aug. China's (10-220MVA) transformer exports to the US pricing was +112% yoy/ +27% mom in Aug; past 3-month rolling average price (June-Aug) +53% yoy.

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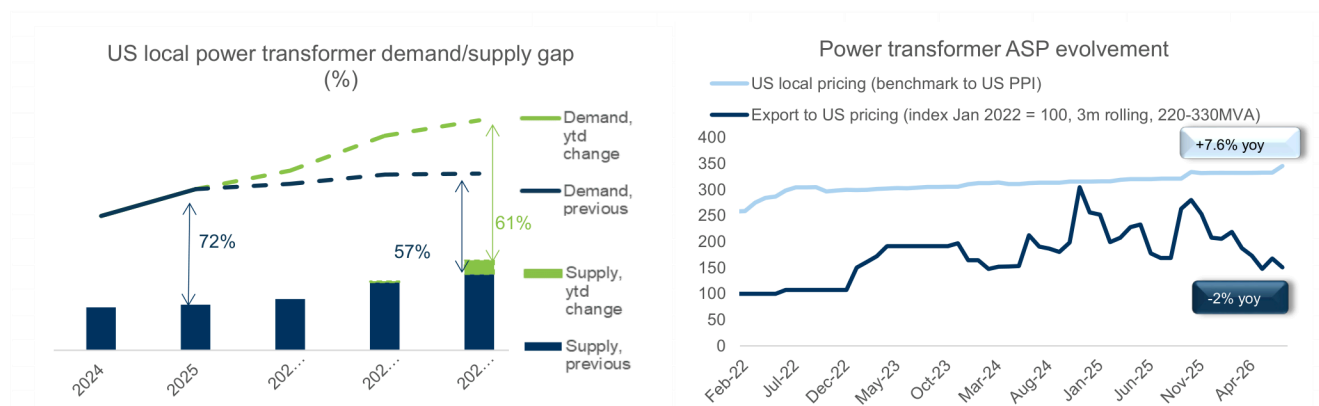
In Aug, China's large (>10MVA) transformer export value showed weakness at -22% yoy (vs. 41% yoy in July); however, exports to the US remained strong at 542% yoy/-33% mom (vs. 132% yoy in July). Meanwhile, South Korea's large (>10MVA) transformer export value growth reached 72% yoy in Aug (vs. 34% yoy in July); large transformer exports to the US grew 56% yoy in Aug (vs. 22% yoy in July).

We now estimate that the **US power transformer demand-local supply gap** will narrow from 72% currently to 61% by 2028E (vs. 57% forecast at the year-beginning). The latest update (on Sep 15, 2026, [link](#)) was Hitachi Energy committing to build another Mississippi transformer factory for USD1.5bn, in addition to other projects in Pennsylvania, Virginia, and Tennessee.

Implications for stocks: August China transformer exports declined 22% yoy, which could be partially interpreted as a lighter overseas seasonality during the summer vacation period. However, the data point showed relative weakness compared with South Korean transformer exports, which increased 72% yoy in August. Despite the weakness of the data point, China's exports to the US remained resilient during the month even after the policy restrictions. Our key ideas remain Buy-rated **Huaming** to benefit from global transformer demand and market share gain potential; **Sieyuan** on export potential, not just limited to transformer exports to the US, but more grid equipment categories to diversified regions globally; and **Nari Tech** as a beneficiary of domestic UHV construction, with growing export potential in secondary equipment, dispatch software, as well as ESS.

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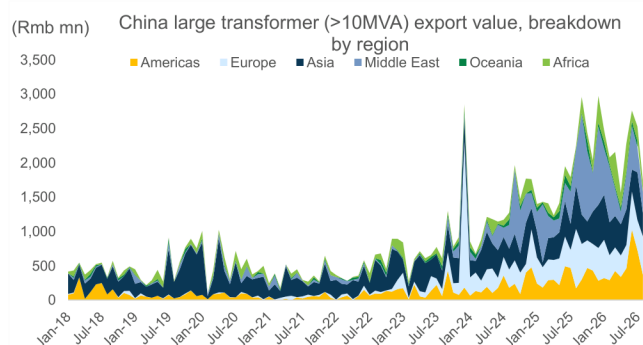
Exhibit 1: We estimate that the US power transformer demand/local supply gap will narrow from 72% currently to 61% in 2028E; despite China export ASP fluctuations, US PPI has stabilized at a high level



China Customs export pricing is on a FOB basis. US local pricing is estimated with a bidding document, then applied with the PPI for transformers of all power range, not 220-300MVA specifically.

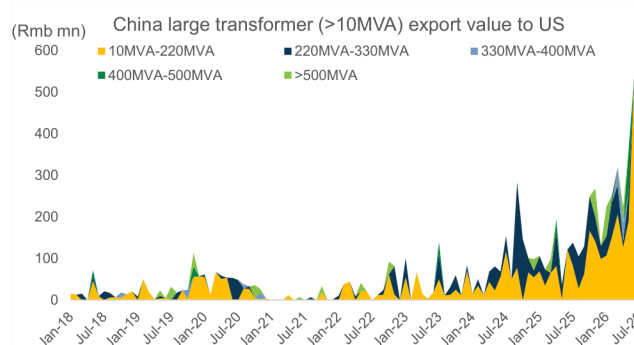
Source: Company data, FRED, State Grid, China Customs, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: China's total transformer export value was -22% yoy in Aug (vs. 41% in July)



Source: China Customs, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 3: China's transformer export value to the US grew +542% yoy in Aug, -33% mom (vs. +132% yoy in July)



Source: China Customs, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Pricing appeared stable at a high level, from US PPI, Korea and China export pricing as well as key raw material pricing perspectives, showing no signs of transformer shortage easing:

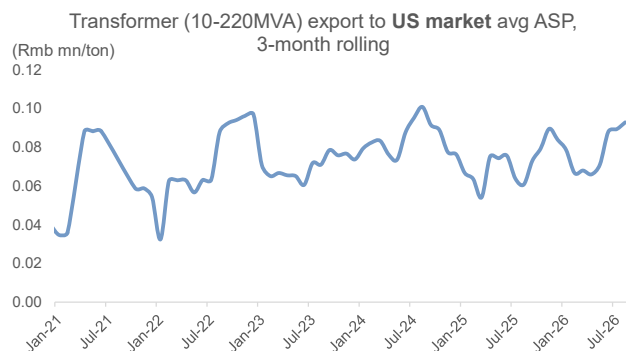
US PPI for power and specialty transformer maintained at 7.6% yoy in Aug; switchgear PPI inched up 4% mom in Aug, reaching 13% yoy, while gas turbine PPI maintained at 5% yoy in Aug.

South Korea's large (>10MVA) transformers export pricing to the US remained relatively stable at a high level (6% yoy, 7% mom in Aug).

China's (10-220MVA) transformer export to the US pricing was +112% yoy/ +27% mom in Aug; past 3-month rolling average price (June-Aug) +53% yoy.

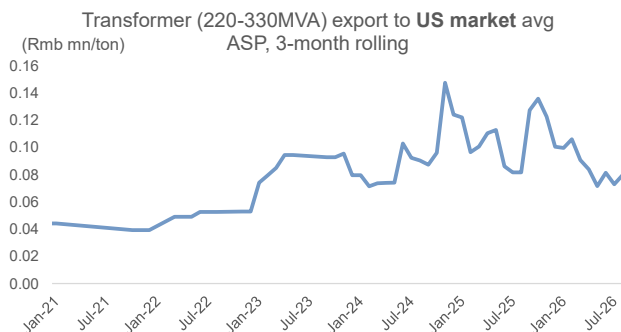
Key raw material for transformers, GOES and copper, saw slight price uptick in July.

Exhibit 4: China's (10-220MVA) transformer export to the US pricing was +112% yoy/ +27% mom in Aug; past 3-month rolling average price (June-Aug) +53% yoy



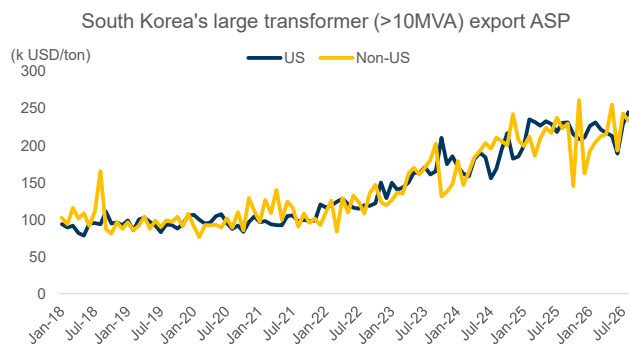
Source: China Customs, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 5: China's (220MVA-330MVA) transformer export to the US 3-month rolling price was -2% yoy (no export to the US in this range in August)



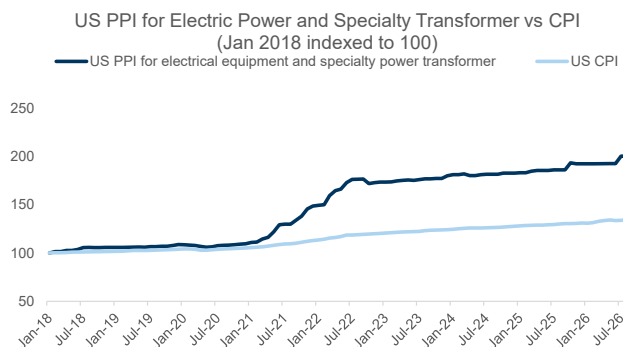
Source: China Customs, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 6: South Korea's large transformer export ASP to the US remained relatively stable at a high level (6% yoy, 7% mom in Aug)



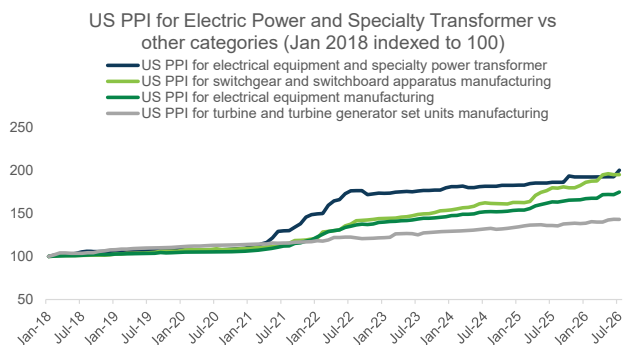
Source: KITA, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 7: US PPI for power and specialty transformer maintained at 7.6% yoy in Aug



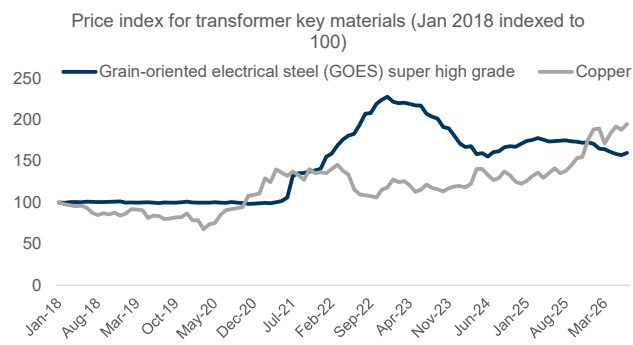
Source: FRED, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 8: US switchgear PPI inched up 4% mom in Aug, reaching 13% yoy, while gas turbine PPI maintained at 5% yoy in Aug



Source: FRED, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 9: Key raw material for transformers, GOES and copper, saw slight price uptick in July



Source: TDEurope, Wind, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

China's large (>10MVA) transformer export value came in at

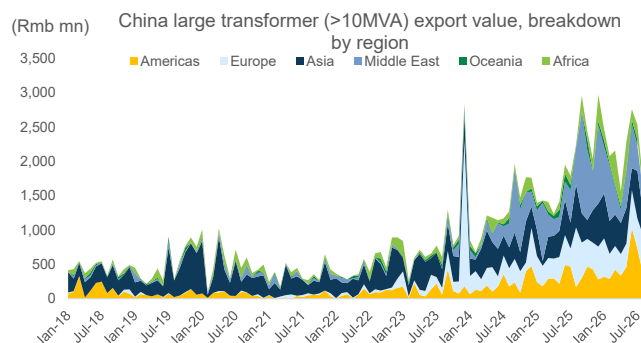
c.Rmb1,744mn/c.USD260mn, -22% yoy in Aug (vs. 41% yoy in July), which was particularly driven by Africa at 311% yoy (9% contribution to total export), Americas at 108% yoy (21% contribution), Europe at -35% yoy (32% contribution), Middle East at -42% yoy (17% contribution), and Asia at -48% yoy (19% contribution).

In particular, transformer export value to the US was c.Rmb179mn/c.USD27mn, growing 542% yoy in Aug, -33% mom (vs. 132% yoy in July). Export breakdown by voltage level was 100% from the 10-220MVA segment.

For other categories, China's electronic meter export value was +0% yoy in Aug (vs. +11% in July); China's circuit breaker (>72.5kV) export value was +8% yoy in Aug (vs. -37% yoy in July).

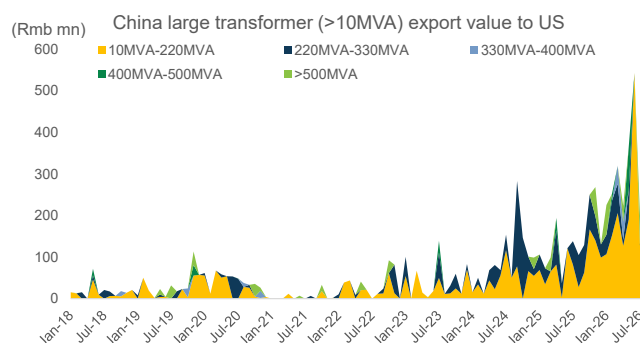
South Korea's large (>10MVA) transformer export value came in at USD176mn (total exports, +72% yoy in August vs 34% yoy in July), including USD98mn **export to the US (+56% yoy in August vs 22% in July)**. Besides large transformers, med transformers/HV Switchgear +GIS/low-voltage switchgear export to the US grew 35%/+213%/+149% yoy.

Exhibit 10: China's total transformer export value was -22% yoy in Aug (vs. 41% in July)



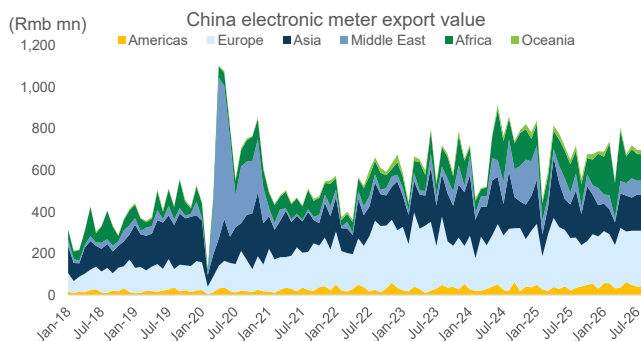
Source: China Customs, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 11: China's transformer export value to the US grew +542% yoy in Aug, -33% mom (vs. +132% yoy in July)



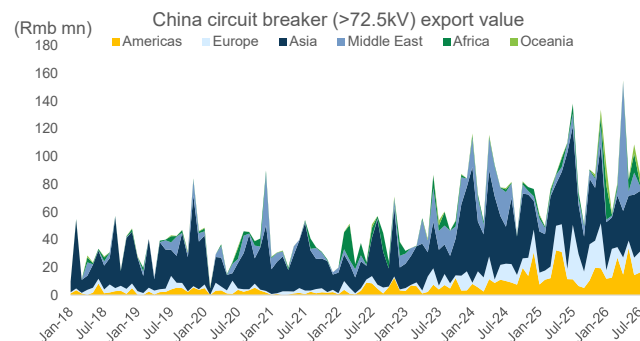
Source: China Customs, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 12: China's electronic meter export value was +0% yoy in Aug (vs. +11% in July)



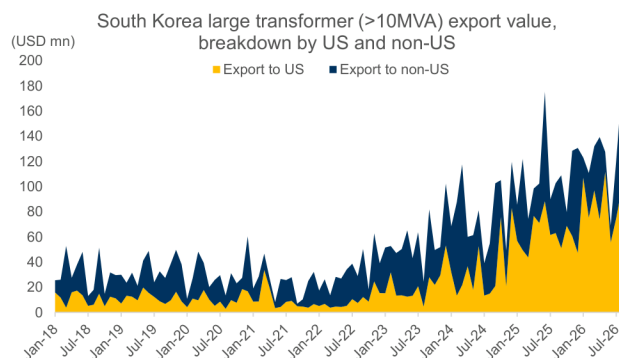
Source: China Customs, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 13: China's circuit breaker (>72.5kV) export value was +5% yoy in Aug (vs. -37% yoy in July)



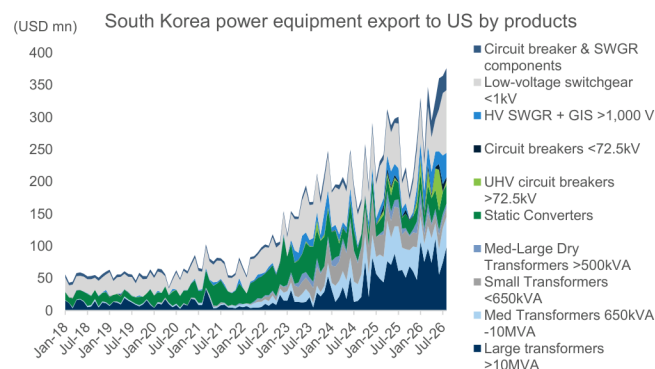
Source: China Customs, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 14: South Korea's large transformer (>10MVA) export to the US/non-US grew +56%/+96% yoy in Aug (vs. +22%/+61% yoy in July)



Source: KITA, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 15: Besides large transformers, South Korea's med transformers/HV Switchgear +GIS/low-voltage switchgear export to the US grew 35%/+213%/+149% yoy



Source: KITA, Data compiled by Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The author would like to thank Zhou Li, Hao Chen, Zhihan Ye, and Junfang Zhang for their contributions to this report.

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